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WhatsApp Re-Design — UI/UX Case Study



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WhatsApp Re-Design — UI/UX Case Study

Introduction

Hello! My name is Nerissa Arviana Sukmananda, a UI/UX enthusiast. I'm currently participating in UI/UX Product Design held by Zenius. I hope this article can describe my team and I have worked on process when solving a problem in an application. Hope you enjoy this!

. . .

Background



WhatsApp — Logo

About WhatsApp

WhatsApp is an application for sending text, voice messages, making voice and video calls, sharing pictures, documents and other media. More than 2 billion people in over 180 countries use WhatsApp to stay in touch with friends and family, anytime and anywhere. Currently, WhatsApp has around 5 billion downloads on the Google Play Store with approximately 172 million reviews which is quite a lot compared to similar apps.

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Problems

WhatsApp is a widely used messaging application. However, there is a decrease in rating due to user difficulties in using some of the features. Users have difficulty pinning messages that cannot be more than 3 messages. Then the user also has to search for messages manually or enter keywords. Lastly, users find it difficult to copy important messages from WhatsApp to other notes apps. With these issues in mind, my focus has been on improving the user experience of WhatsApp by redesigning its user interface and incorporating new features.

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Goals

Based on the problems above, the following is the purpose of redesigning the WhatsApp, including:

- Knowing the user's needs in using Whatsapp
- Understand the behavior of users who have difficulty in using WhatsApp
- Knowing the comfort that the user wants in using WhatsApp

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Role in the team

During the WhatsApp redesign process, I collaborated with 4 other team members, namely:

1. Asif Mahardhika Ramadan
2. Lisa Agustina
3. Siti Latifah
4. Putri Zalsabila.K

In creating design solutions, we have the same responsibilities as UX researchers such as:

- Doing user research,
- Generating solution concepts, and
- Perform usability testing,

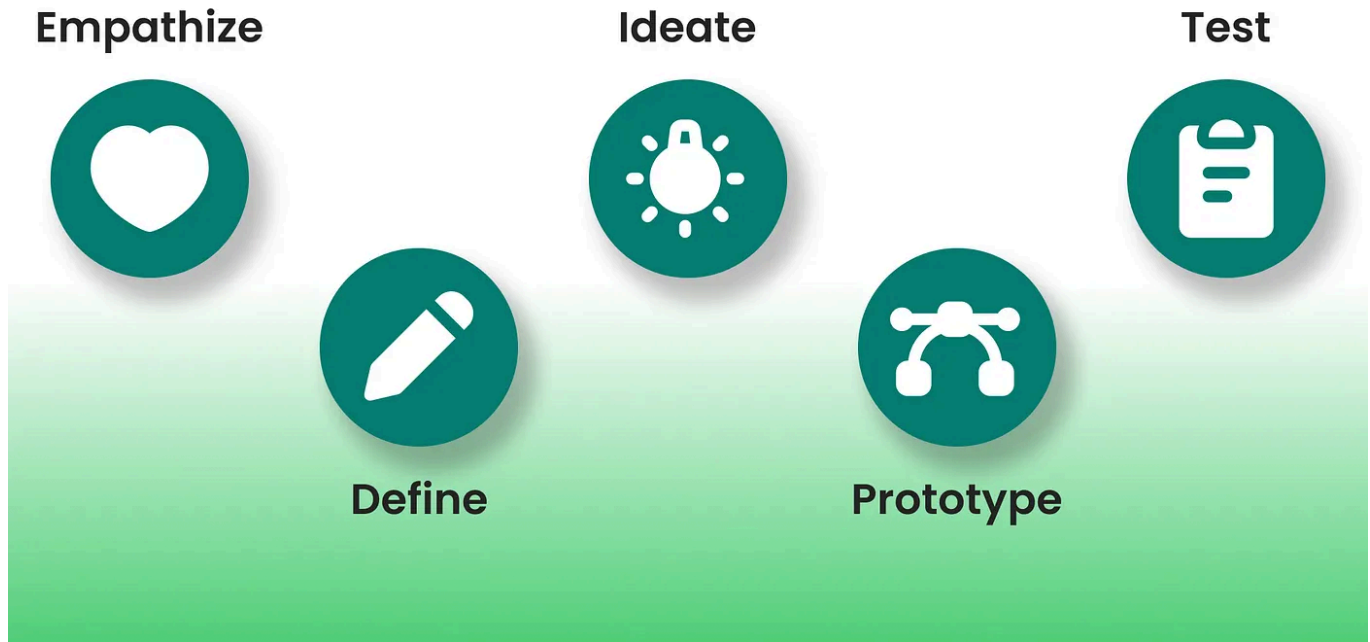
However, I am responsible for UI Design work such as creating user flows, wireframes, user interface (high-fidelity design), and prototyping.

Previously, all the team members did their own UI Design work, but in the end it was my design that was selected.

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Design Process

In this project we use the Design Thinking approach to solve existing problems. Using this method can help us understand well about user needs. The following are the steps taken in the design thinking process:



Design Thinking — Redesign WhatsApp

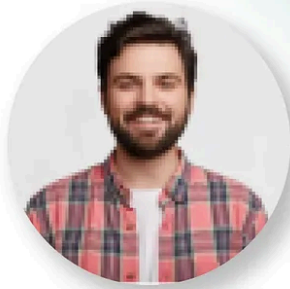
Empathize

This initial process is the stage for finding problems with WhatsApp. Here are the target users of WhatsApp:

- Active users of the WhatsApp application
- 16–40 years old
- Active online on WhatsApp with more than 4 hours a day
- Often use WhatsApp to send messages

Explore and understand the user experience when using WhatsApp. In addition, to collect data related to constraints or problems experienced by users when using the WhatsApp application. The type of data collected is qualitative data obtained through online surveys with respondents.

User Persona



ASIF MAHARDHIKA

Age: 21

Occupation: College student

Location: Jember, East Java

PAIN POINTS

- The pin chat feature is limited.
- Searching for message takes a long time because not based on date.
- To make personal notes is still manual and I have to create a group first as a room chat to make notes.

NEEDS

- Notes and personal reminder features.
- Unlimited chat pins.
- Search for messages by date.

GOALS

- User can add many chat priorities.
- Make notes for users in recording activities.
- Applications that can make it easier to communicate.
- Efficiency when searching for messages.

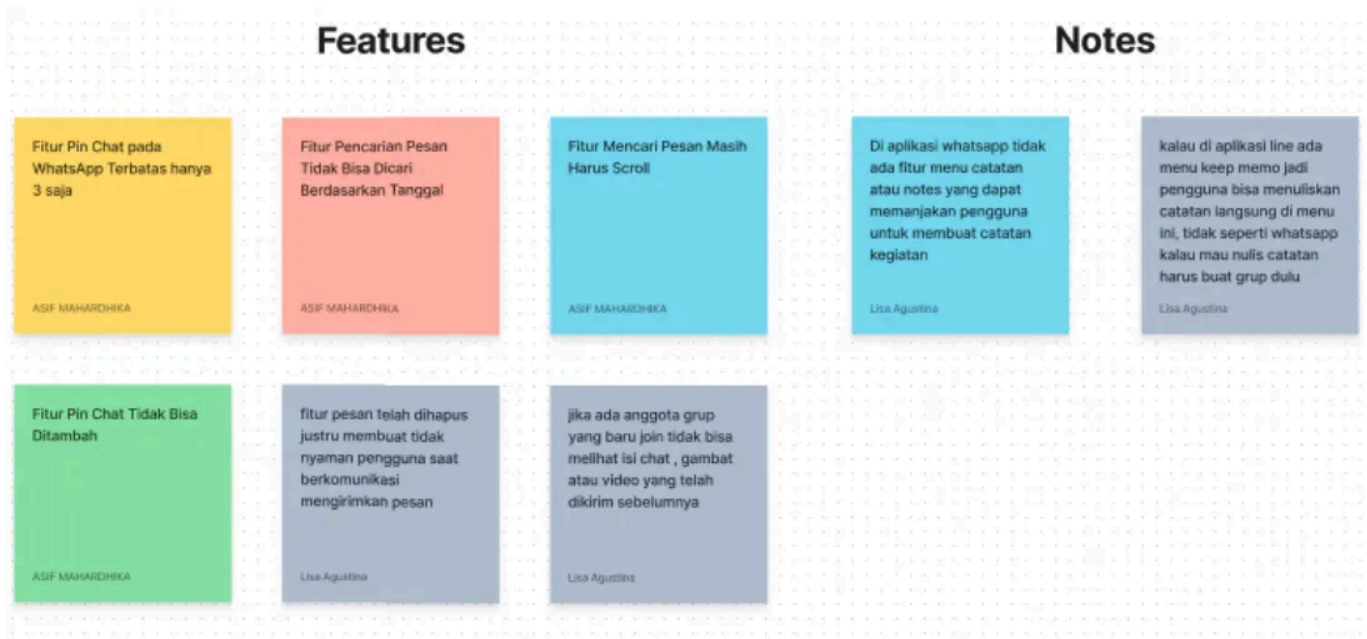
User Persona — Redesign WhatsApp

Define

The next stage in the define stage is that I make observations by making affinity diagram and user journey maps to look for opportunities that can be applied to the product.

Affinity Diagram

The insights obtained from the results above are represented using an affinity diagram. Using the affinity diagram technique can help us discover embedded thought patterns by sorting and grouping information.



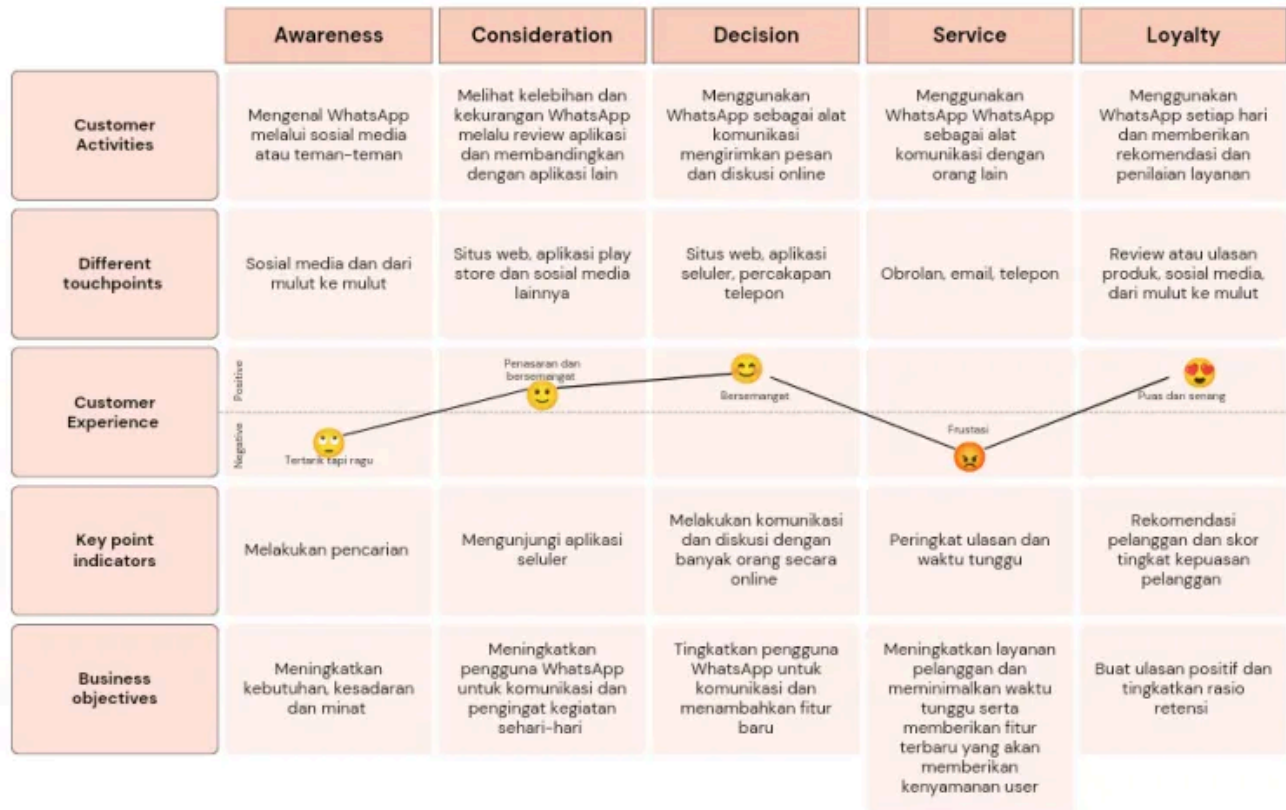
Affinity Diagram — Redesign WhatsApp



Affinity Diagram — Redesign WhatsApp

User Journey Maps

After getting some information from before, the next step is to create a user journey map model. The user journey map is a visualization of the process that the user goes through in reaching the destination.



User Journey Maps — Redesign WhatsApp

Defining the Problems

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Based on the results of the analysis using affinity diagrams and user journey maps, 3 main problems faced by users were found. The 3 main problems are:

1. User have difficulty pinning messages due to more than 3 unpinnable chats.

2. User have difficulty finding messages according to the date of the message, so they have to search manually or scroll it.
3. Users feel uncomfortable and make it difficult to save notes in chat rooms.

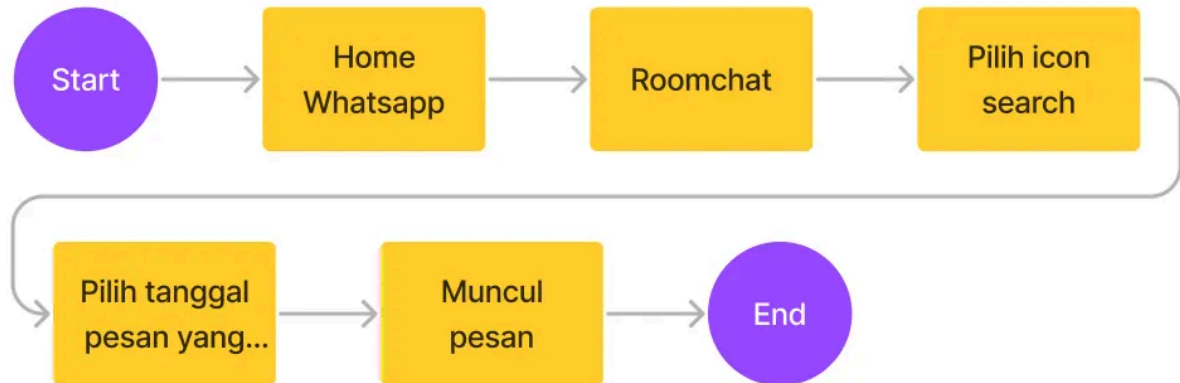
Ideate

At this stage I create user flows, information architecture and wireframes.

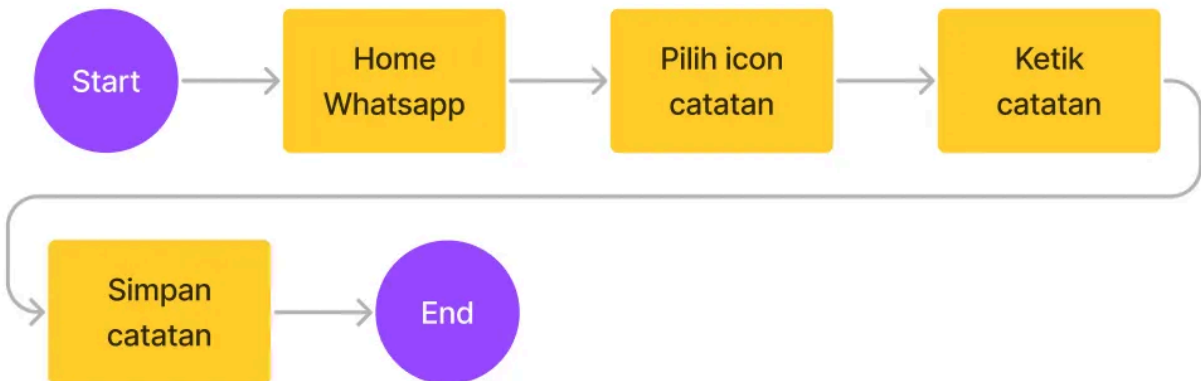
User Flow

I created a user flow to describe the journey a user must complete when searching for messages by date, creating a new note, and using pin chat.

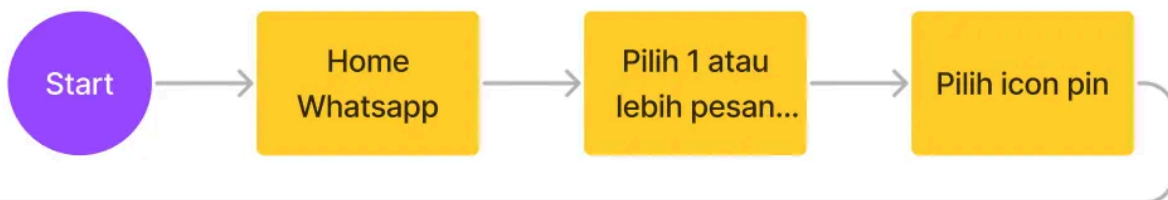
FITUR SEARCH PESAN BERDASARKAN TANGGAL



FITUR CATATAN



FITUR PIN CHAT TAK TERHINGGA



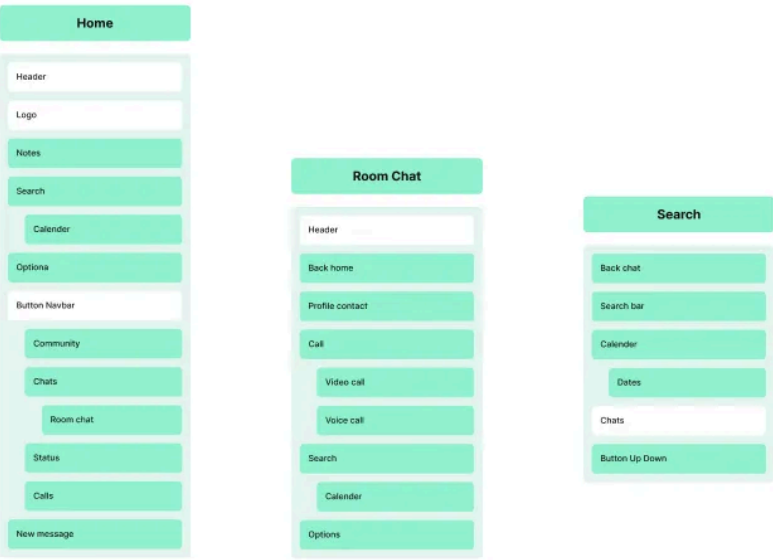


User Flow — Redesign WhatsApp

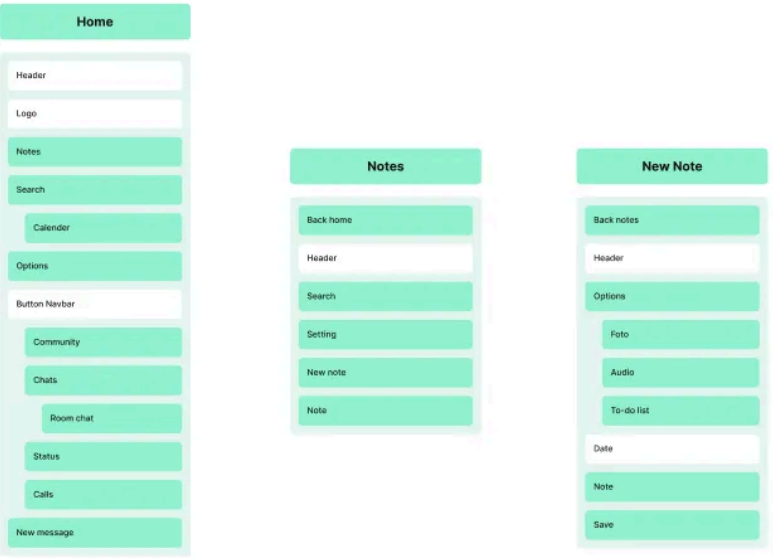
Information Architecture (IA)

After I created the user flow, the next step was to create an information architecture to make the flow clearer.

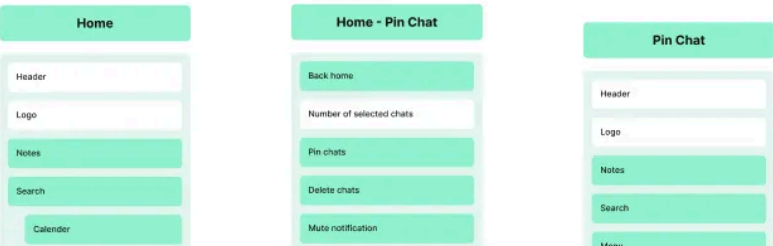
FITUR SEARCH PESAN BERDASARKAN TANGGAL

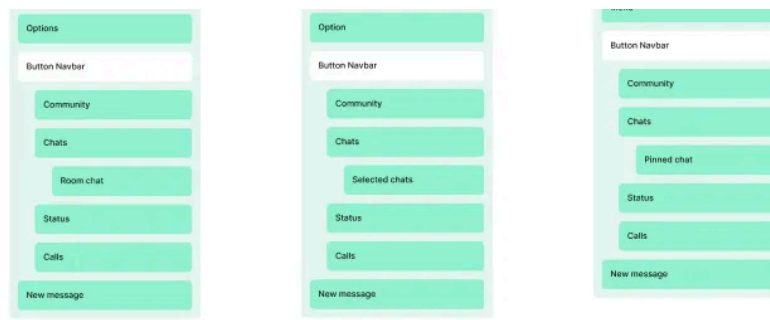


FITUR CATATAN



FITUR PIN CHAT TAK TERHINGGA

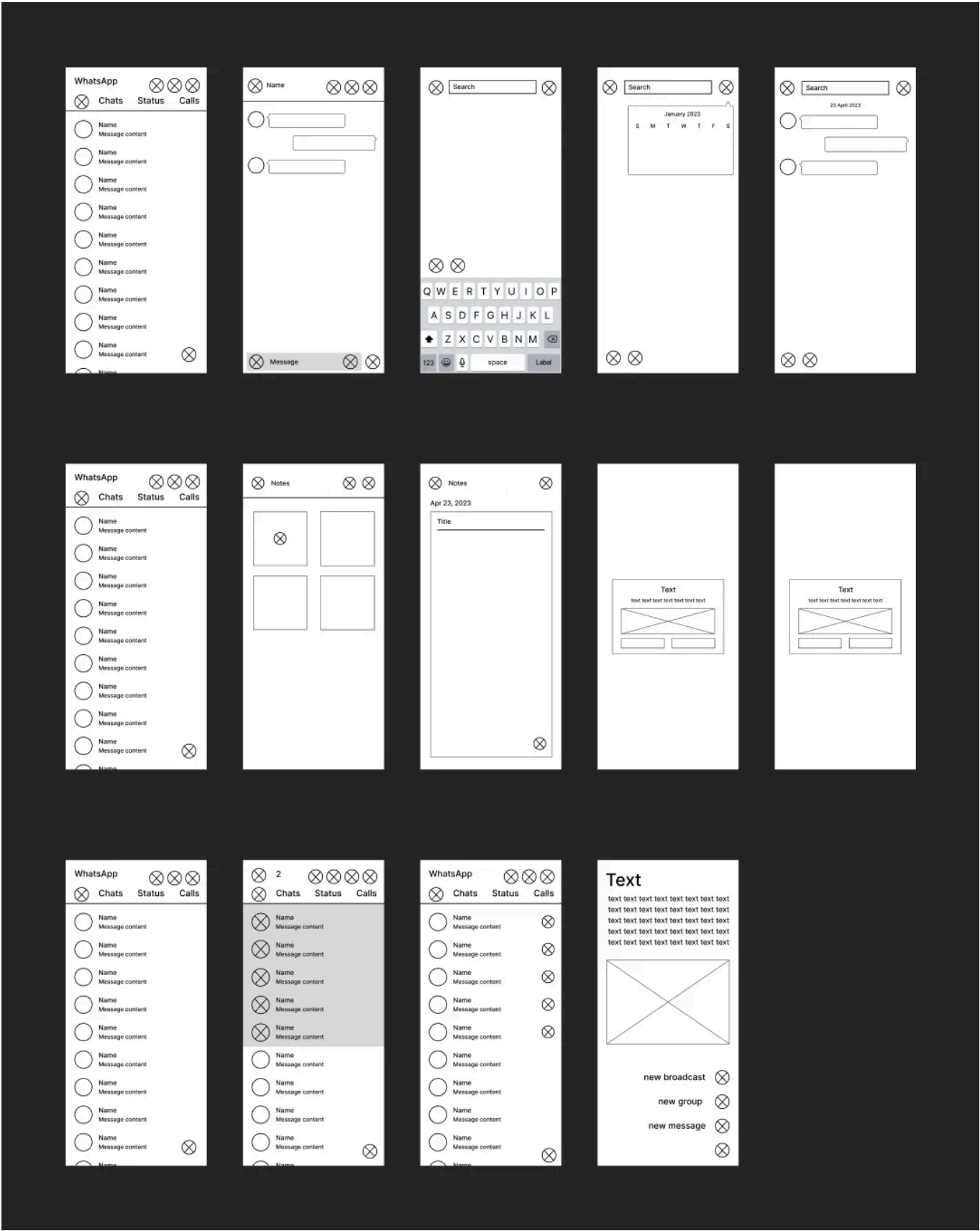




Information Architecture — Redesign WhatsApp

Wireframe

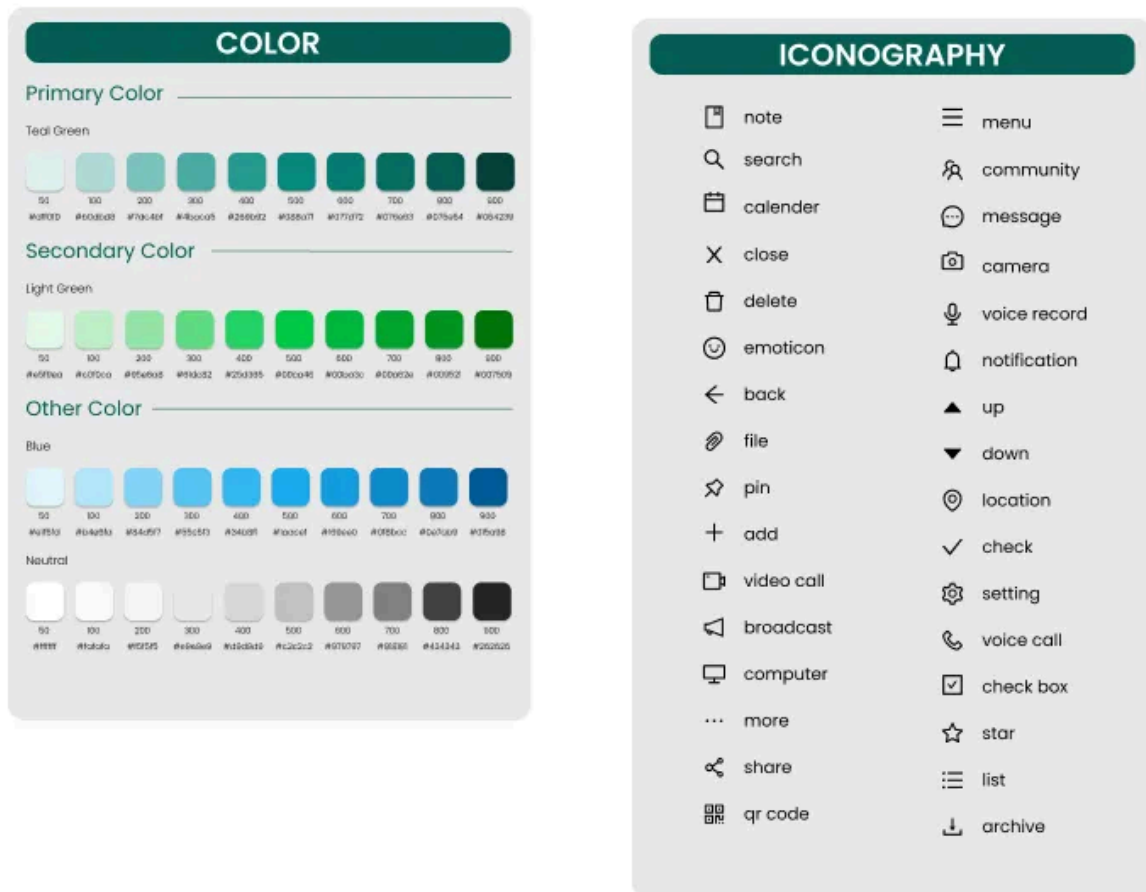
I started to create wireframe process from low fidelity to high fidelity design. I visualize concepts into wireframes with low accuracy. Low-fidelity is a layout that can assist designers in presenting information in an interface.



Wireframe — Redesign WhatsApp

Design System

Before developing it into a UI design, I first decided on colors, typography, iconography, and made important components such as buttons and cards with their respective variants. The design system will continue to evolve along with the user interface design process.



Design System — Redesign WhatsApp

TYPOGRAPHY

Type Scale

Name	Font Style	Weight	Size	Example
Heading 1	Poppins	Bold	32px	WhatsApp
Heading 2	Poppins	Bold	24px	WhatsApp
Heading 3	Poppins	Bold	16px	WhatsApp
Body	Poppins	Regular	14px	WhatsApp
Caption	Poppins	Regular	12px	WhatsApp
Button	Poppins	Medium	16px	WhatsApp

BUTTON

Primary Button

Without icon

Icon only

Without icon small

Normal

On Press

Disabled

Without icon

Icon only

Without icon small

Secondary Button

Without icon

Icon only

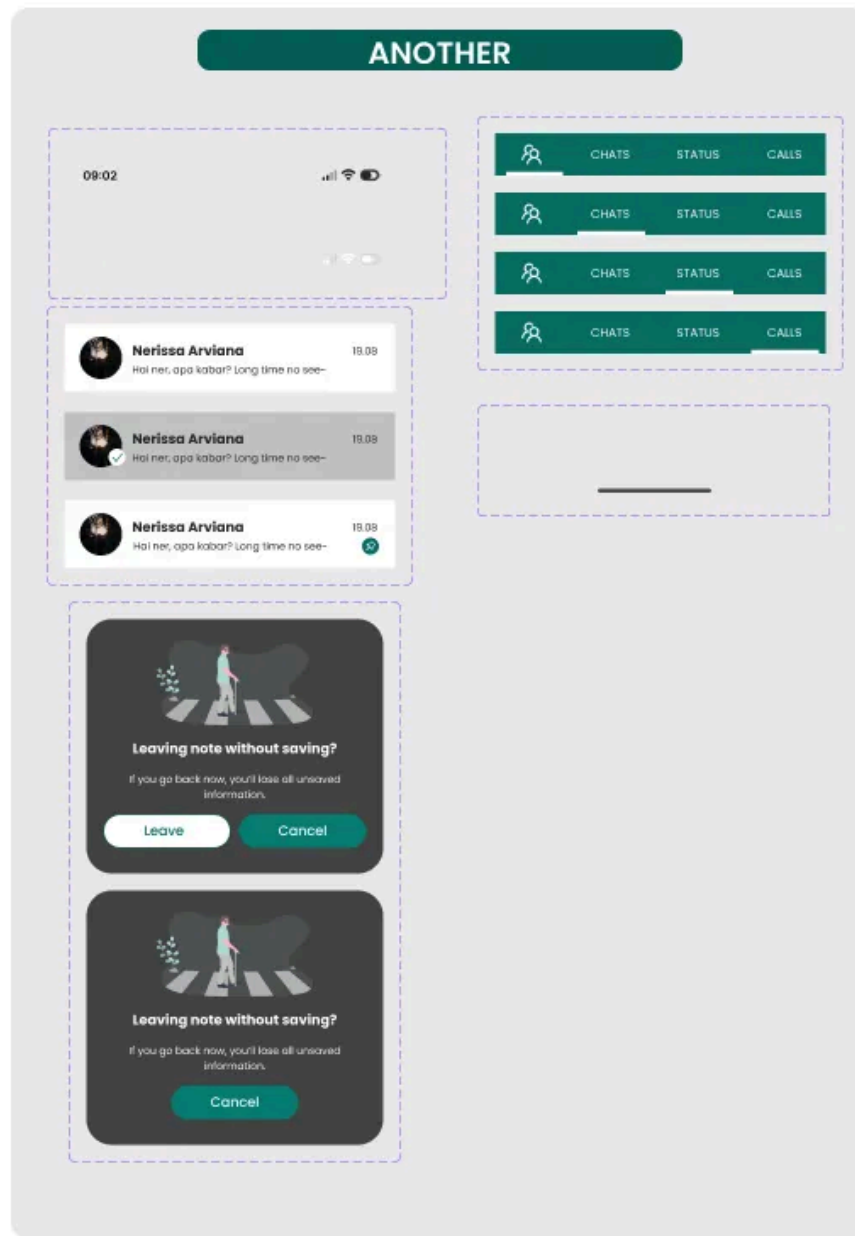
Without icon small

Normal

On Press

Disabled

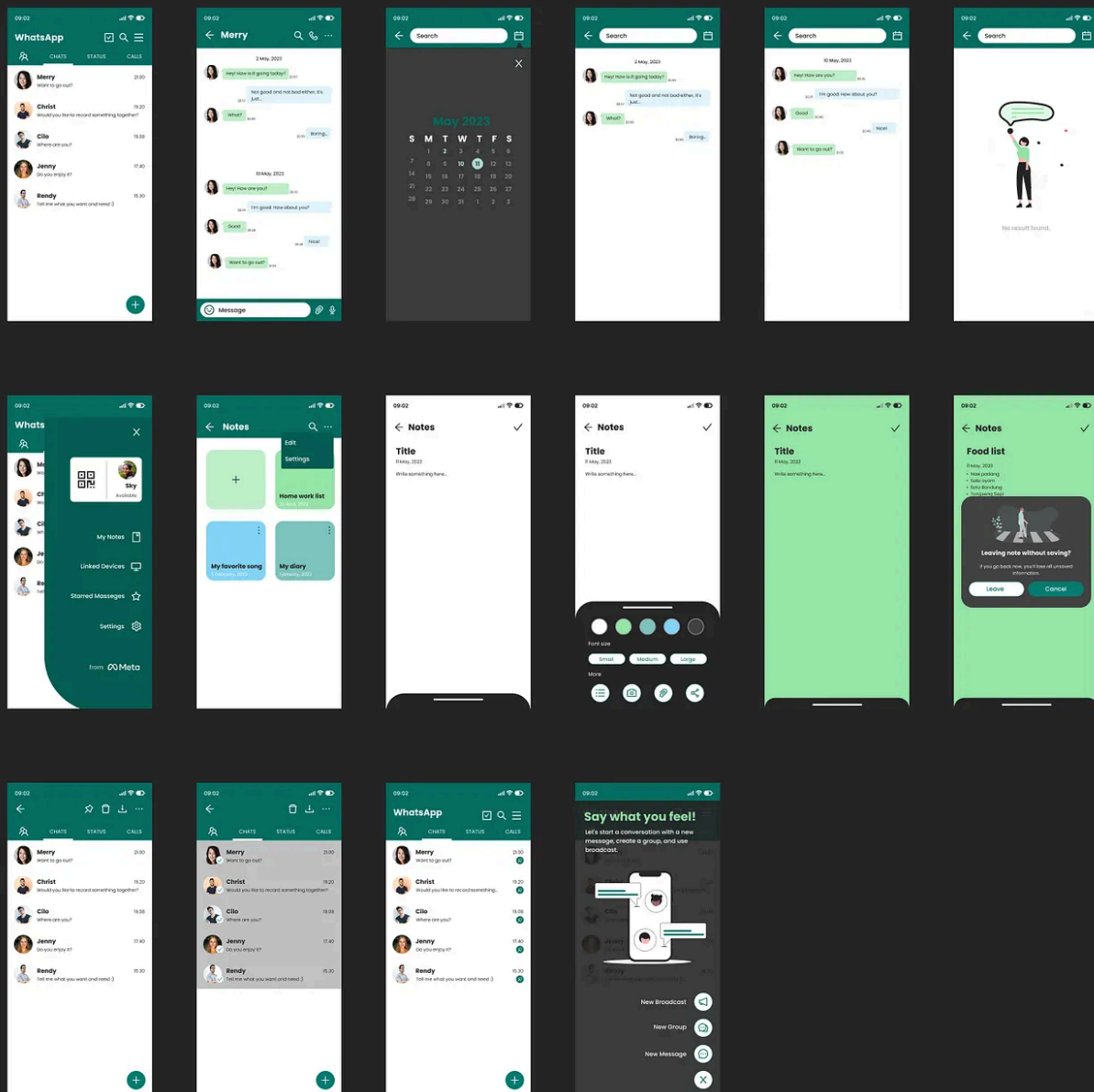
Design System — Redesign WhatsApp



Design System — Redesign WhatsApp

High Fidelity

Here's a High-fidelity I've created based on a previous wireframe.



High Fidelity — Redesign WhatsApp

Prototype

At this stage we implement the ideas that have been made into a more interactive interface. This aims to find out how the product can run according to the expected flow. See the prototype below:

Testing

At this stage we carried out Usability Testing with 5 respondents. We use in-depth interviews to explore how user feedback can be more in-depth. This UT was carried out to evaluate the new design of searching messages by date, making notes, and unlimited pin chats.

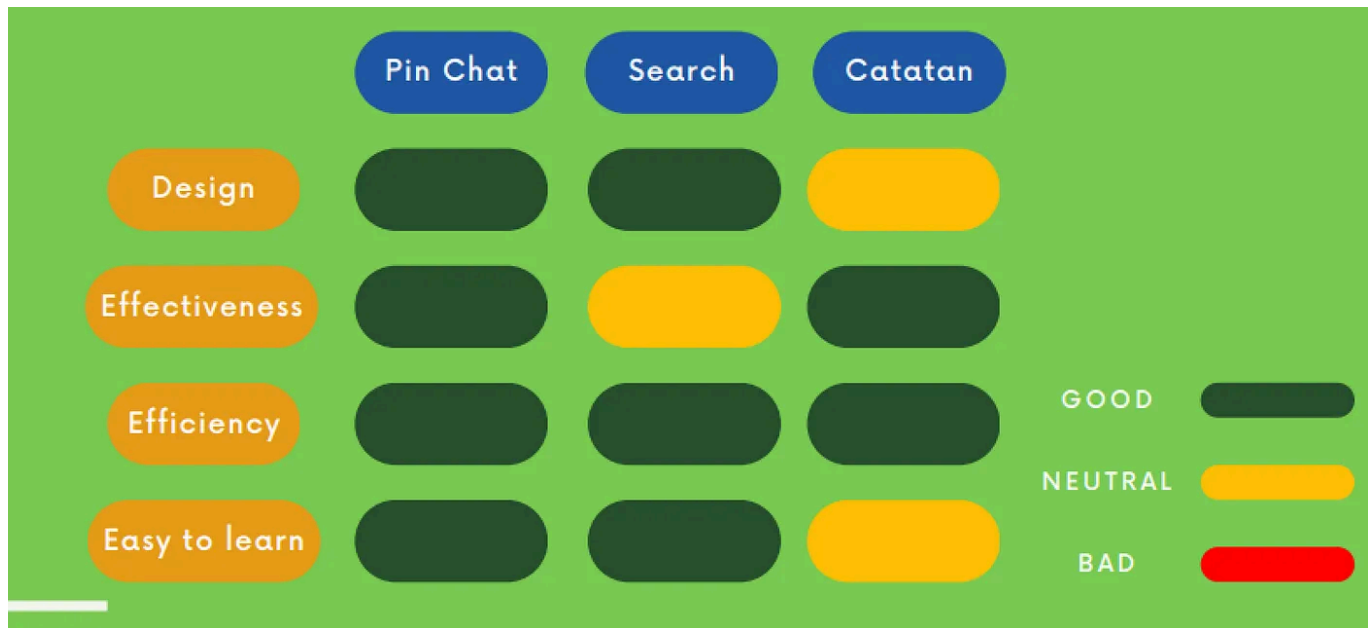
Participants

Segment	WhatsApp User	Competitor User	Age
User 1	✓	✓	21 Tahun
User2	✓	✓	22 Tahun
User 3	✓	✓	21 Tahun
User 4	✓	✓	22 tahun
User 5	✓	✓	22 Tahun

Participants — Redesign WhatsApp

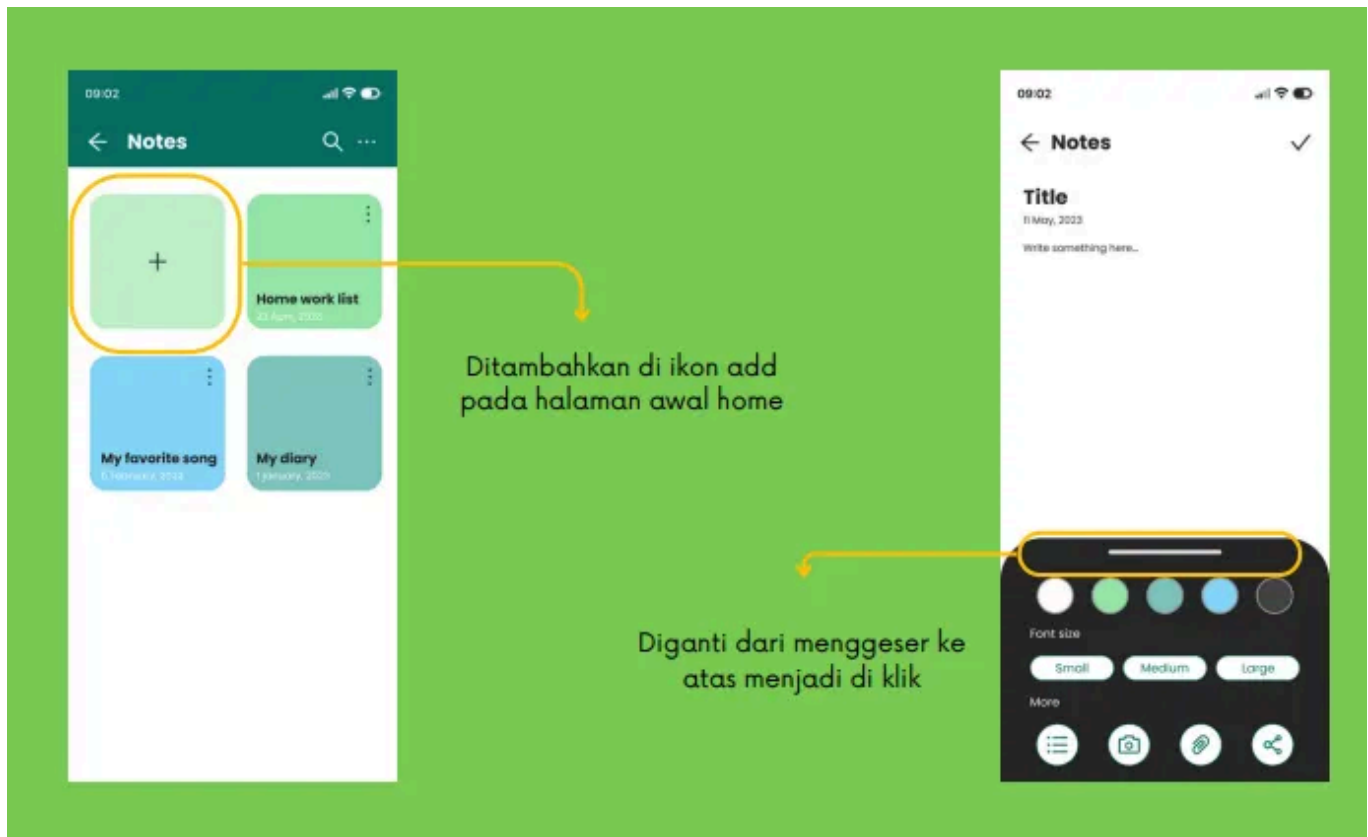
Overall Evaluation

Overall, users feel that the newly added features are quite convenient and useful, it's just that more adaptation is needed for the application.

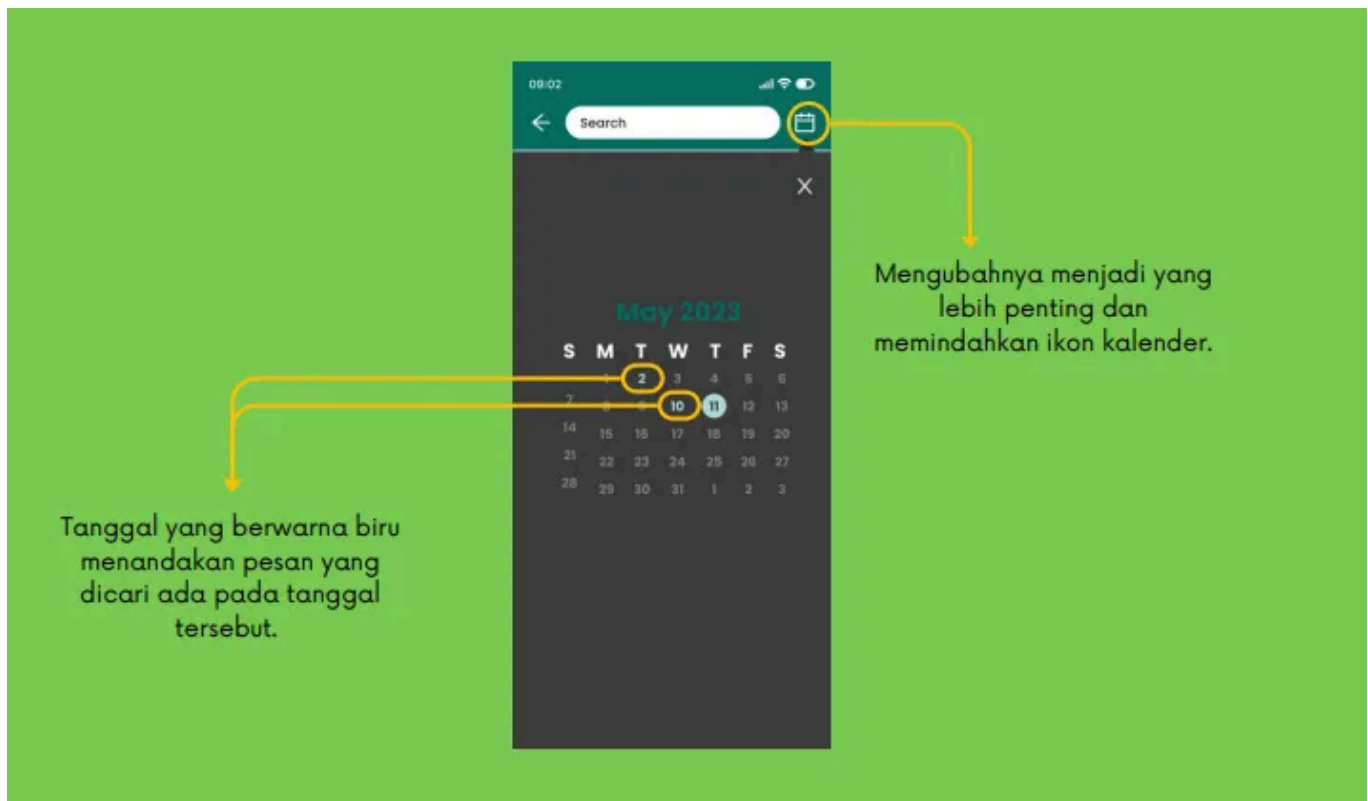


Overall Evaluation — Redesign WhatsApp

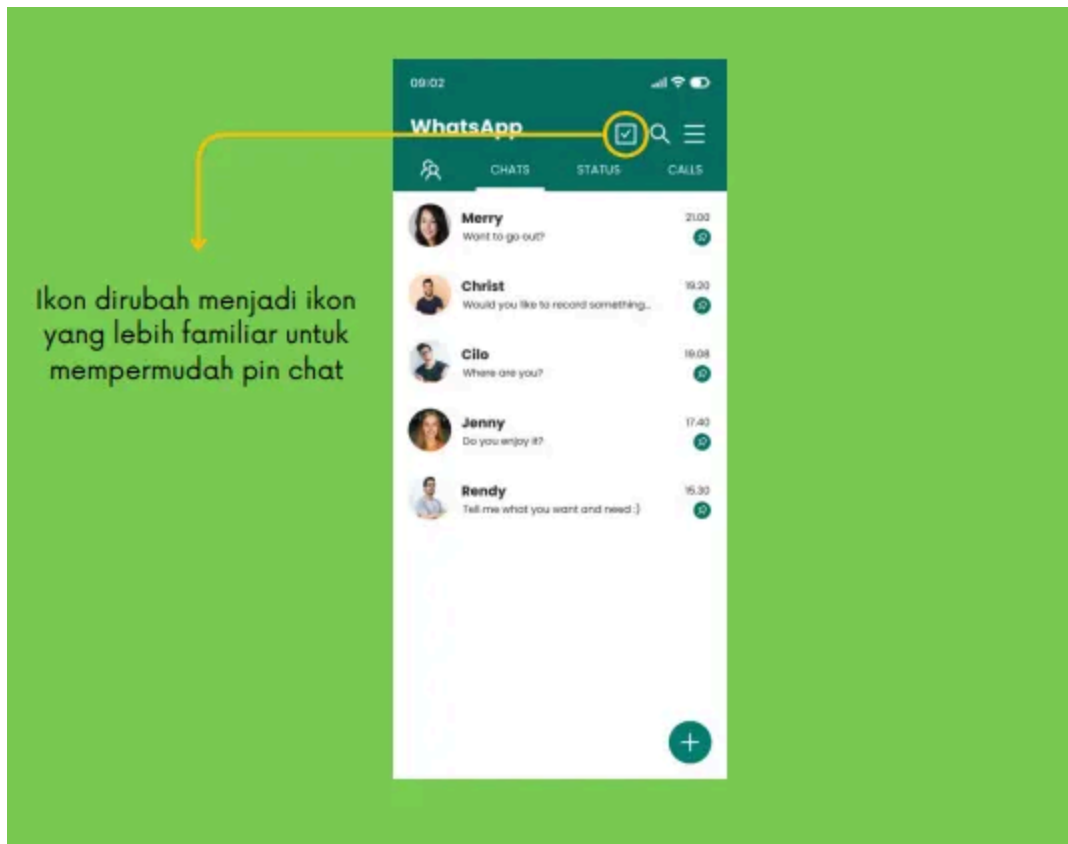
Design Feedback



Design Feedback — Redesign WhatsApp



Design Feedback — Redesign WhatsApp



Design Feedback — Redesign WhatsApp

According to the test results above, I have to make some improvements. However, due to time constraints, improvements will be made at a later time.

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Conclusion

In the process of working on this project, it can be concluded that:

1. All participants often use the WhatsApp application every day to send messages, make calls, and send files.
2. Reasons to use WhatsApp compared to other applications such as telegram and Twitter. Because on WhatsApp the features are more diverse and according to needs and easy to access.

3. There are users who say that the message search feature according to date is less important because people usually forget the date they chatted automatically.
4. There is one user who does not understand the intent and purpose of the line button at the bottom when making notes.
5. The average participant said that all the features developed from scenarios 1–3 were all very important and necessary for the user.
6. On average, all participants gave a score for each scenario, namely a rate of 6–7.

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Closing

So that's the end of this project. The writing and design solutions in this application are far from perfect. During this research process, I learned a lot from users. Thanks to the team for working together.

To the readers, I also want to thank you for reading my article. Hopefully this can benefit everyone. I'm very open to any feedback.

Thank You!

Nerissa Arviana Sukmananda ♥



Written by **Nerissa Arviana**

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Hello! I'm Nerissa, A fresh graduate in Software Engineering from Universitas Pendidikan Indonesia with a strong interest in UI/UX Design and related fields.

